

Related Work

Parameter-Efficient Fine-Tuning (PEFT)

LoRA (Low-Rank Adaptation)

Hu et al. (2021) introduced *LoRA*, a simple yet powerful technique for parameter-efficient fine-tuning. By freezing the pretrained model and injecting trainable low-rank matrices into attention projections, LoRA achieves near-full fine-tuning performance with less than 1% additional parameters and no extra inference cost.

This method established the foundation for all later adaptive or dynamic LoRA variants.

→ *BA-LoRA builds directly on LoRA's architecture but replaces fixed-rank adapters with adaptive, budget-aware ones.*

Adaptive Rank Allocation and Efficiency Improvements

AdaLoRA (Adaptive Budget Allocation for LoRA)

Zhang et al. (ICLR 2023) proposed *AdaLoRA*, which adaptively redistributes rank across layers based on importance scores while respecting a total parameter budget.

It prunes less useful adapters and increases capacity in critical layers, achieving better trade-offs between efficiency and accuracy.

→ *BA-LoRA adopts AdaLoRA's core idea of budget-constrained rank allocation but replaces heuristic pruning with explicit gradient-based importance estimation.*

ALoRA (Adaptive/Automatic Low-Rank Adaptation)

ALoRA automates rank discovery by jointly optimizing rank parameters during fine-tuning, minimizing manual tuning of hyperparameters.

Rather than pruning post hoc, ALoRA learns which layers benefit from higher rank through the training objective itself.

→ *BA-LoRA shares ALoRA's goal of rank adaptivity but uses pretraining gradients and budget allocation instead of meta-optimization, improving interpretability and stability.*

DyLoRA (Dynamic LoRA)

Valipour et al. (2023) proposed *DyLoRA*, which trains LoRA blocks for a **range of ranks** simultaneously, enabling post-training rank adjustment without retraining.

It removes the need for costly rank searches and accelerates tuning by sorting learned subspaces across ranks.

→ *BA-LoRA extends this flexibility through static yet **budget-aware dynamic allocation**, balancing efficiency and adaptability while maintaining control over total parameters.*

Scaling LoRA to Large Language Models

QLoRA (Quantized LoRA)

Dettmers et al. (NeurIPS 2023) demonstrated that LoRA can be combined with **4-bit quantization** to fine-tune 33B–65B parameter models on a single 48 GB GPU without quality loss.

Their method introduces 4-bit *NormalFloat* quantization, *Double Quantization*, and *Paged Optimizers*,

forming the basis for modern instruction-tuned open LLMs like Guanaco.

→ While BA-LoRA does not perform quantization, it addresses the complementary problem of maximizing accuracy **within a fixed parameter budget**, making it a natural partner or upstream step for QLoRA-style compression.

Gradient-Guided Adaptation

GoRA (Gradient-Driven Adaptive LoRA)

He et al. (2025) introduced GoRA, the first framework to jointly handle **adaptive rank allocation** and **nonzero initialization** using gradient statistics.

It computes the importance of each weight matrix via gradient-weight sensitivity and allocates rank accordingly, initializing adapters with pseudo-inverse-based compressed gradients.

→ BA-LoRA generalizes GoRA's insight by using accumulated gradient importance but replaces pseudo-inverse initialization with an **SVD-based warm start** for numerical stability and reproducibility.

References

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